

LSE Department of Government Policy on the Use of Generative AI in Assessment

*This policy applies to all GV*** courses.*

The Department of Government permits the **limited use of generative AI in assessment**.

Generative AI refers to computer systems that create or modify text, images, audio, video, and code. Such systems include, but are not limited to, ChatGPT, Claude, and Copilot.

Summary advice for students

- Treat AI-generated content like an unverified source, with appropriate scepticism.
- Do not copy or paraphrase from generative AI.
- Be prepared to show evidence of your work-in-progress (strategies in Appendix B).

Authorised uses

- **Students may use generative AI for tasks that support learning and research** without disclosure, specifically (a) brainstorming ideas, (b) finding relevant literature and generic code examples, (c) clarifying terms, concepts, and software error messages, and (d) obtaining constructive feedback.
 - *Constructive feedback refers to critical suggestions and advice, comparable to feedback from a peer; it does not generate new content.*
 - *Students retain full responsibility for the accuracy and veracity of their work*
- **Students may use generative AI to suggest corrections to grammar and spelling** without disclosure.
- **Students may use generative AI to generate computer code, classify documents, and engage in other data analysis tasks** with disclosure through the inclusion of a Generative AI Appendix.
 - *A Generative AI Appendix consists of (a) a brief statement describing the AI tool(s) and how it was used (no more than 200 words) and (b) all prompts, inputs, and other information necessary to reproduce the output.*
 - *Only (a) is required for AI code autocompletion tools (e.g., GitHub Copilot).*
 - *The Generative AI Appendix is excluded from the word count.*
 - *Assessments of students' ability to write or use computer code may be subject to additional provisions as designated by the course convenor.*

No other uses of generative AI are authorised for formative or summative assessments.

This means, among other restrictions, students must:

- Not use generative AI to produce an outline of their work
- Not copy, paraphrase, or otherwise adapt content generated by AI
- Not use generative AI to generate bibliographic references
 - *Dedicated bibliographic software, such as EndNote or Zotero, is permitted*

Procedures

- During the marking process, if an examiner believes **a submission is more likely than not** to have been created with the unauthorised use of generative AI (see detection strategies in Appendix A), the student may be invited to **provide time-stamped, non-editable evidence of work-in-progress** (see examples of evidence in Appendix B).
- If evidence is not provided in a timely manner and/or the examiner continues to suspect unauthorised AI use, **the submission will be investigated** according to the School's [AI Assessment Misconduct Guidance](#) process.

Resources for students

- Moodle course, "[Generative AI: Developing your AI Literacy](#)"
- LSE Digital Skills Lab workshop, "[Generative AI \(Claude & Copilot\) Workshop](#)"
- Data Science Institute, "[Guidance on the use of generative AI to support research](#)"

Questions and support

- For questions about this policy, students should consult their course convenor.
 - *For further information or clarification, contact the AI Department Lead (Dr Michael Lerner).*
- For technical support with AI tools, contact the [Digital Skills Lab](#)

Appendix A – Detecting unauthorised AI use

This is a non-exhaustive list of strategies course convenors may use to detect unauthorised AI use in assessment. No convenor is required to employ any of these tools.

- Course convenors may note a systematic failure to engage with course materials, the use of unusual spelling or phrasing, or the citation of fictitious sources.
 - *For further discussion of this strategy, see [AI Assessment Misconduct Guidance](#), para. 10.*
 - *Note that, whether or not unauthorised AI use has occurred, submissions with such characteristics will usually receive low marks, as indicated in departmental marking schemes.*
- Course convenors may use automated systems to estimate the probability of AI use for all or a selection of submissions for a specific assessment.
 - *Course convenors are encouraged to contact the Department's PSS staff for guidance on appropriately using and interpreting automated systems.*
- Only if announced well ahead of the assessment deadline, course convenors may adopt a [randomized interview procedure](#) to interview students about the originality of their work for a specific assessment.
 - *As per the School's procedure, randomized interviews may trigger, but do not substitute for a formal investigation for AI assessment misconduct.*

Appendix B – Evidence of student work-in-progress

This is a non-exhaustive list of types of evidence for demonstrating work-in-progress:

- Intermediate drafts and version histories – most writing programs have this built in
 - *Instructions for viewing version histories in [OneDrive](#), [Google Workspace](#), and [Dropbox](#)*
- Writing process tracking tools (e.g., [Grammarly Authorship](#)) – software that records time spent working on a document, text additions and deletions, and/or a recording of the writing process.
- Time-stamped reading notes, outlines, and other preparatory materials.

*This policy may be updated as circumstances warrant. When this occurs, GV*** students will be informed by email.*

Last revised August 2025